XVIII: 263). ***Mill*** was of the opinion that mass society is self-repressive in nature which would lead to the sapping of human energy and potential. The Victorian society he claimed was governed by an ethos of propriety based on Christian self-denial while in contrast ***Mill*** encourages the Greek model of self-development. It is important for society to create conditions where individuals can develop their own ways of living. This will enable variety and diversity of character and culture which will become the engine of productive tension that will drive a nation forward. ***Mill***'s insistence throughout On Liberty, sought to preserve the individual's freedom against the possibility of legislative or state coercion and also from the deceptive forms of social coercion.

Considerations on Representative Government

In 1861 ***Mill's*** Considerations on Representative Government was published which contains his views on politics. ***Mill*** was a convinced democrat, however, this work reveals his disappointment, doubts, and difficulties about self-government. His view is paradoxical in nature where he views that the majority ought to rule but minority rule was probably right. He argued that majority has power but the minority has wisdom. ***Mill*** in this work expresses the dangers posed by the tyranny of the majority undertook to provide the criterion for good government. He concluded that ideally the best form of government was one that was representative where the sovereignty is vested in the entire aggregate of the community, every citizen who not only have the right to at least occasionally be called on to take an actual part in the government by the personal discharge of certain public function, local or general.

Assessment

John Stuart ***Mill*** occupies a very important place in the history of political thought which was widespread in the nineteenth century. His works emphasized the importance of human nature for the proper study and understanding of the state. He developed his own philosophy of franchise. ***Mill*** states that casting one's vote is as necessary for the political animal as is the air that he or she breathes. No other political thinker has been as emphatic as ***Mill*** in the conception of voting. The influences that utilitarianism had on ***Mill*** also were important in the formulation of his ideas on the principle of economy and that of representative government where the freedom of the individual to develop his capabilities should be never interfered with. On each of these subjects ***Mill*** was often provocative that no student of the discipline can afford to ignore.

DO YOU KNOW?

❖ Utilitarianism: Greatest happiness of the greatest numbers.

❖ Even though ***J.S. Mill*** has been brought under the guidance of utilitarian thinkers like ***James Mill*** and ***Jeremy Bentham,*** he gave a different notion of utilitarianism.

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